

Opinion on the Royal Supremacy

QUESTION PRESENTED: Whether the King's Majesty may lawfully be recognised as the supreme head of the Church in England, and the cause of his marriage determined within the realm without recourse to Rome.

SHORT ANSWER: Yes. The ancient privileges of this realm, and the authority of Convocation and Parliament, are sufficient to the purpose.

ANALYSIS: We advise that an Act be drawn restraining appeals to Rome, declaring this realm an empire entire of itself. The Archbishop of Canterbury may then hear and determine the cause at home.

This memorandum reflects confidential legal advice prepared at the King's request and is protected from disclosure.

Respectfully submitted for the King's eyes only.